🚵 Desi Cycling Club

How DCC Weekly Activities Works

A plain-English guide to how the app keeps your data safe, stays fast, and never hits Strava's limits — across iPhone, iPad, and Apple TV.

THE PROBLEM WE SOLVED

⚠️

The old way was breaking

Every time you opened the app, it asked Strava directly for the club's data. But Strava has a limit — only 200 requests every 15 minutes for the entire app, shared across all users. With 30+ members opening the app, we kept hitting that wall, and you'd see "403 error" or no data at all.

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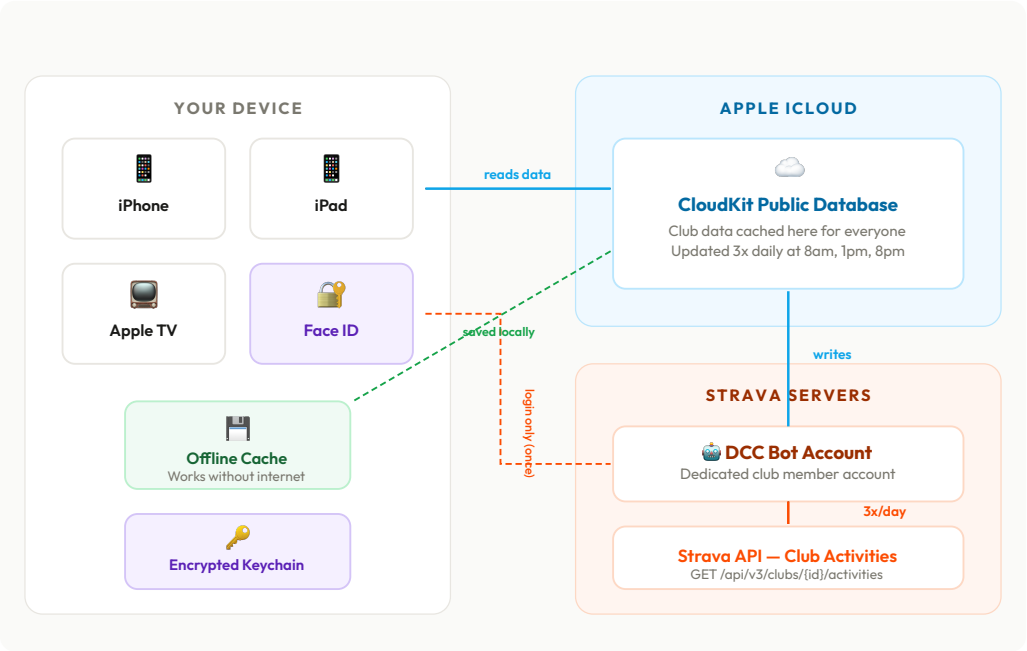
The new way is bulletproof

Now, a dedicated "DCC Bot" account fetches the data 3 times a day — morning, lunchtime, and evening. Your app reads from that pre-fetched cache. Whether there are 5 or 500 members, Strava only sees about 9 requests per day. Problem solved forever.

	BEFORE	AFTER

Strava API calls per day	~~90+ (and growing with each new member)~~	~9 total (fixed, regardless of members)
Your login is used for	~~Identity AND data fetching~~	Identity only (proving you're a DCC member)
Data freshness	~~Live but unreliable (often blocked)~~	Updated 3x daily, always available
Offline support	~~None — blank screen with no internet~~	Full — last fetched data always cached on your device
Risk of errors	~~High — 403 errors when limit hit~~	Near zero — 98.5% of limit is free

THE BIG PICTURE



HOW IT WORKS ON EACH DEVICE

📱 iPhone | 📱 iPad | 📺 Apple TV

STEP 1 — FIRST TIME ONLY

🔗 Connect with Strava

You tap "Connect with Strava" and a secure browser opens. You log in with your Strava username and password. The app only asks for basic "read" permission — it cannot see your private activities, change your data, or post anything.

This proves you're a real person with a Strava account. Your Strava password is NEVER stored in the app — Strava handles the login directly.

STEP 2 — FIRST TIME ONLY

✅ Club membership verified

The app checks whether your Strava account is a member of the Desi Cycling Club. If you are — you're in. If you're not a DCC member on Strava, the app politely tells you to join the club first.

This keeps the app exclusive to DCC members. No one outside the club can access our data.

STEP 3 — EVERY TIME YOU OPEN THE APP

🔐 Face ID / Touch ID

After your first login, the app uses Face ID (or Touch ID on older iPhones) to verify it's really you. No more typing passwords. Your login token is stored in the iPhone's encrypted Keychain — the same vault that protects your banking apps.

Even if someone picks up your phone, they can't access the app

without your face or fingerprint.

STEP 4 — AUTOMATIC, IN THE BACKGROUND

☁️ Club data loads from iCloud

The app fetches this week's club activities from Apple's iCloud servers — NOT from Strava. A dedicated "DCC Bot" account has already collected the data 3 times today (at 8am, 1pm, and 8pm) and stored it in iCloud for everyone.

This is why the app never hits Strava's limits. 30 members opening the app = 30 reads from iCloud (unlimited and free), instead of 30 calls to Strava.

STEP 5 — YOU'RE IN

📊 See your club's stats

Charts, tables, leaderboards, individual rider stats — all displayed instantly from the cached data. Pull down to refresh from iCloud anytime. A small "Updated 2 hours ago" label shows how fresh the data is.

Even without internet (e.g. on a ride in the countryside), the app shows the last data it downloaded. You're never stuck on a blank screen.

YOUR DATA IS SAFE

🔑 Your Strava password

NEVER stored in the app. You log in directly on Strava's website. The app only receives a temporary "key" (token)

🔐 Your login token

Stored in Apple's Keychain — the same encrypted vault that protects your credit cards in Apple Pay. Cannot be

that expires every 6 hours.

read by other apps.

👤 What the app can see

Only your basic profile (name and photo) and that you're a DCC member. It CANNOT see your private activities, routes, heart rate, or personal data.

🚫 What the app cannot do

Cannot post on your behalf, modify your activities, message other athletes, or access any data beyond basic "read" permission.

☁️ Club data in iCloud

Weekly club activities (distances, times, elevation) are stored in Apple's iCloud servers. This is aggregate club data — not your personal Strava data.

🤖 The DCC Bot account

A real Strava account that's a DCC club member, controlled by the app administrator. It fetches club data 3x daily. Your personal Strava account is never used for data fetching.

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No personal data leaves your device

The app processes everything locally on your iPhone, iPad, or Apple TV. The only data that travels over the internet is the weekly club activity stats (which are already public on Strava's club page) and your basic profile for identity verification. We follow Apple's privacy guidelines and never track you.

JARGON BUSTER

OAuth

The system that lets you log in via Strava without giving the app your password. Like when a website says "Log in with Google" — same idea.

API

The way apps talk to each other. When DCC fetches data from Strava, it's using Strava's API — a structured way to request information.

Rate limit

CloudKit

A cap on how many times an app can ask Strava for data. Like a speed limit for requests — go over it and you're blocked temporarily.

Apple's cloud storage for apps. Like iCloud Drive but for app data. Free, fast, and built into every Apple device.

Keychain

Apple's secure vault on your device that stores passwords and tokens. Protected by encryption and your Face ID / Touch ID. Same system as Apple Pay.

Token

A temporary digital "key" that proves you logged in. Like a wristband at a festival — shows you paid to get in without needing to show your ticket again.

CURRENT STATUS — MARCH 2026

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Strava approval pending (7-10 business days)

Strava requires all new apps to apply to their Developer Program before multiple users can connect. We've submitted our application. Until it's approved, only the app developer can log in — everyone else will see a "403: Limit exceeded" error. This is a Strava requirement, not a bug in our app. Once approved, all DCC members will be able to connect.

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What's already working

The app is fully built and live on TestFlight (Apple's beta testing platform). Authentication via Strava OAuth, Face ID / Touch ID security, weekly stats dashboard with charts and leaderboards, iPad layout, and offline caching are all complete and tested. The moment Strava approves our capacity increase, we flip the switch and you're all in.

Roadmap after launch

Once the core app is live: Apple TV support for the clubhouse big screen, Lock Screen widgets showing your weekly stats, push notifications for new leaderboard positions, and historical week-over-week trends. Your feedback during beta will shape the priority order.